Waste & Circular Economy Daily Briefing — November 09, 2026

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The takeaway Ontario has narrowed the review process for changes to where waste comes from and how fast landfills fill, making direct notices more important for host municipalities.

At a glance

- A Fort McMurray acquisition brings commercial collection and site sanitation under one owner.
- Québec's planned carton deposit expansion is drawing scrutiny over where returned material can be processed.
- A Czech audit shows how a larger share of unavoidable scraps can pull down a food-waste indicator even when avoidable food still makes up a sizable share of garbage.

Ontario shifts landfill operating changes to the approval process

In a decision posted November 6, Ontario removed environmental assessment requirements for changes to waste disposal sites' service areas and landfill fill rates. A site seeking to go beyond the service area or fill rate specified in its Environmental Compliance Approval still needs to apply for an amendment. The exemption from Part II of the Environmental Bill of Rights removes registry posting for these applications and the associated right of third parties to seek leave to appeal. The ministry says it will notify host municipalities directly. Existing requirements for increasing total disposal volume or changing accepted waste types still apply. Ontario decision notice.

For municipal capacity planning, track where a site can accept waste from, how fast it can fill, and how much approved capacity remains as separate fields. A site that fills faster can run out of space sooner.

Collective adds commercial waste and site services in Fort McMurray

On November 6, Canadian Middle Market reported that Calgary-based Collective Waste Solutions acquired TLC Disposal and A1 Portables, both serving Wood Buffalo. TLC provides commercial waste collection and roll-off containers. A1 provides portable sanitation, septic and vacuum truck services, and water hauling. For a buyer tracking backup vendors, the deal is a reminder to record parent companies alongside operating names so that two listings under the same owner are visible as such. Canadian Middle Market transaction note.

Québec’s carton expansion raises a processing question

On November 6, Québec solidaire called for a new deposit rollout plan, and the head of the Front commun québécois pour une gestion écologique des déchets raised concerns about Québec's ability to process the additional cartons in-province. RECYC-QUÉBEC lists March 1, 2027 as the scheduled date for adding eligible

glass and carton containers for ready-to-drink beverages from 100 mL to 2 L. It says residents can put the containers awaiting coverage in curbside recycling. For municipal tonnage forecasts, the two dates to track are when cartons move into the deposit stream and when processors can take the resulting material. Québec solidaire statement, 98.5 interview summary, RECYC-QUÉBEC guidance.

Research follow-up — report both sides of the food-waste ratio

The Czech study highlighted Friday was published in full on November 6. In Rožnov pod Radhoštěm, the ratio of avoidable to unavoidable food in residual garbage fell from 1.39 in the spring sample to 0.56 in the late-summer sample. The avoidable share fell from 21.36% to 13.59% of residual waste by weight, while the unavoidable share rose from 15.36% to 24.16%. These are two sorting campaigns, and the audit covers residual garbage only. Published study, Table 2 and limitations.

Worth acting on In the next Banff/Canmore audit, report both food fractions as shares of the sorted garbage sample alongside any ratio. This makes it clear whether a change in the ratio reflects a shift in one fraction or both.